

SURREY SCOUT

NOVEMBER, 1980

No. 400

Chief Scout

I am delighted to have this opportunity of writing your County Newsletter the "Surrey Scout", especially on such an occasion as the 400th edition. What a splendid record to have achieved! Some of you will no doubt recall the first issue which appeared in 1944, while many more will certainly remember that up to 1967 the "Surrey Scout" was known as the "Surrey "S" Sheet".

Good communication at all levels is vital to the Scout Movement if it is to function smoothly and

efficiently, and the various forms of newsletters issued by Counties, Districts and Groups, are the arteries through which the life blood of Scouting pulses.

Surrey has been fortunate in maintaining a high standard of communication through the "Surrey Scout" and I would like to congratulate all those responsible for its production over so many years and to send my very best wishes for its continued success in the future.

WILLIAM GLADSTONE

County President

I have been asked, in my capacity as President of the Surrey Scout Association, to write a short piece for this the 400th issue of "Surrey Scout", but I must at once emphasise that I am in no position to pontificate about the future of Scouting in Surrey.

I was once a Wolf Cub, and later for a short time a Boy Scout, but this was some sixty years ago; I had no further contact with the movement until I became Lord Lieutenant, and soon afterwards President of the Association, in 1973. Indeed, I did not even realise until it was politely but firmly pointed out to me that the terms I have used for my early membership were no longer in use. So I can only give my views as a virtual outsider.

My first surprise came when I discovered the very large number of people who were involved with Scouting in Surrey. I knew a little about some of the other organisations for young people in the County; none of them can claim nearly so many.

Next, I was greatly impressed by the way in which Scouting had moved with the times. Even in my day Boy Scouts were apt to be looked on as rather an out of date, Kiplingesque lot; now I found something which seemed well attuned to capture the interest of the young people of today, combining comradeship with the challenge of adventure. Clearly if this were not so Scouting would not attract such large numbers.

Prince Philip spoke recently in another context of "one very important factor in boys' lives and that is the tribal element". He continued "Boys like to gang up. I think it is good sense belonging to a group who are friends and with which you can compete against other groups of the same sort of people. It does a tremendous lot for making people feel attached to society and not just living on the fringes of society".

This seems to me to epitomise what Scouting has to offer in the best possible form, and I have no doubt will continue to provide.

HAMILTON of DALZELL

Chief Scout's Commissioner

As I've only received the last fifty issues of "Surrey Scout", I can't speak for the previous 350. Well, what would we do without it? My Unit all read it and we find that we are well in touch with all that happens in the County. We are made aware that there are Scouts

outside our village after all. What an achievement that is, others will never know, so good luck to "Surrey Scout" for the next 400 issues.

BADEN-POWELL of GILWELL
V.S.L., Ripley V.S.U.

County Commissioner

It is clear from the congratulatory messages about "Surrey Scout" which we have received, including those from Lord Hamilton our President, and Sir William Gladstone Chief Scout - all of which are reproduced in this the four-hundredth edition - that our monthly County newspaper is achieving its aim of communicating news, forthcoming events and other items of interest affecting Scouting in Surrey. The need for good communications is unquestioned and the fact that 3,200 copies of each edition are printed and distributed to Districts regularly on the last Sunday of each month, eleven times a year, is indicative of our endeavour to "do our best" to achieve at least one facet of establishing good communications within the County.

But this is only a start. As I have pointed out before it is essential that copies of "Surrey Scout" are disseminated rapidly throughout Districts to Group level where the bulk of Scouting activity takes place. Full marks therefore to those Districts who achieve this within the first week of each month - and a bonus to those who include their own District letter! Where this is not happening, no doubt District Commissioners will wish to ensure that corrective measures are taken swiftly.

The whole purpose of County and District newsletters, together with that of the national magazine "Scouting" - copies of which should be made available to every Leader in the County to read - is to enable everyone involved in Leadership or Administration to do their job more effectively.

As a second facet, communications must be oral as well as written. One only has to mention Blackpool or Brighton to build up a mental image of the two main political parties hammering out their policies. Mention York and, within Scouting circles, we should immediately think of the National Scout Conference at York held in September. It was good to see that Surrey had the largest County contingent at the

Conference, though I would have preferred the numbers to have been more evenly spread over the Districts.

The Conference was extremely well organised, and, I am sure enjoyed by all those who participated. Space does not permit a summary here, but no doubt there will be extensive coverage in "Scouting" shortly. Many useful points were made in discussion which will be debated in the sectional sub-committees first at County level and then I hope within the Districts and Groups.

As a personal reaction, all that I heard and saw at the Conference reinforced my conviction that a large amount of paperwork flowing out from Headquarters County or District is going to be fully effective unless and until all Group Scout Leaders hold regular meetings of all Leaders in each Group.

Apart from keeping up-to-date on Scouting in the wider field, such meetings enable all Leaders in the Group to discuss the progress and development of Scouting in that Group. It helps to develop good working relationships between the Leaders in the different Sections and together they can work out what the progressive training scheme really means in practice when applied to each individual youngster in the Group. The standard of training in each section must be such as to enable Cub Scouts to pass easily and confidently on to the Scout stage and thence on to Venture Scouting.

It is our privilege to be able to pay a part in assisting the physical, mental and spiritual development of young people through the game of Scouting. This means that we also have the responsibility to do our best to equip ourselves with every means at our disposal and using every facet of communications, to discharge that responsibility to the very best of our ability and to help others to do so as well.

GORDON BATES

"400 Not Out"

Having 'signed off' last month as A.C.C. (Scouts) I now find myself being asked to contribute again to "Surrey Scout", but this time in honour of the 400th edition. I am delighted to respond to this request, as I have contributed to "Surrey Scout" - and its predecessor the "Surrey 'S' Sheet" - many times since 1961. I estimate that it must have amounted to about 40 times as A.C.C. (Training) 1961/1965; 95 times as County Commissioner 1965/1973; and getting on for 25 times as A.C.C. (Scouts) 1978/1980. It could therefore be said that I have used 40% of the 400

issues to pass on information, express opinions and throw out a few challenges!

I have always placed the greatest importance on "Surrey Scout" as a vehicle of communication, and whilst at times one has not always been sure that what has been written has been read, I do know that there have been many loyal and avid readers over the years. "Surrey Scout" has served me well, and it is my earnest hope that it will go on serving the County of Surrey for many more years to come.

JIM ELLIOT

County Chairman

When this publication first appeared Scouting was just half its present age of 72 years. Much development had already occurred and much progress has been made since. One of the innovations of the "second half" was the institution of the appointment in each County of a Chairman and the first holder of the new office in Surrey was Mr. John Moore who brought his very wide experience of the Movement to the role which he continued to play until passing the honour to me in 1976.

There have been other innovations in Surrey and at least in the area of adult support. Attention has been more focused on the contributions made by members' parents and by friends of Scouting who act as Chairmen, Secretaries, Treasurers, Public Relations Officers and committee members. Today it is evident that the social need for Scouting is greater than ever and that, therefore, adult supporters need more knowledge of aims, methods and organisation

in order to enable Commissioners and Scouters to give maximum attention to leadership without the distraction of administrative matters which can be so ably handled by supporters at Group, District and County levels.

In the immediate future, therefore, I look forward to intensification of our efforts to give a full and proper introduction to every new adult supporter so that he or she is in no doubt how best to act. We are working on the provision of outline "briefs" for some of these tasks and, hopefully, they will be discussed at the next meeting of District Administrators which, please note, will be on Sunday, February 15th.

Another important concern is the County Camp and Leader Training Site, Bentley Copse. As a County this is our greatest single asset and has a great potential. Here again supporter help is going to be required but more of this next month.

GEOFFREY WRIGHT

Leader Training Courses

General Information Courses

Guildford	5th & 12th November 1980	F. Parker, 70 Agraria Road, Guildford.
Reigate	16th November 1980	Mrs. M. Leppard, 24 Colman Way, Redhill.

Scout Fellowship

Leatherhead	30th November 1980	E.J. Mackie, 30 Morton Road, East Grinstead.
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Basic Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Reigate	6th/7th December 1980	R. Penfold, 49. Wolverton Gardens, Horley.
Purley	14th/15th February 1981	D. Brown, 21 Longsmead, Blindley Heath.
Surbiton	14th/15th March 1981	Miss M. Pooley, 71 Beech Grove, Mitcham.
Guildford	21st/22nd March 1981	J. Gibbons, 115 Hermitage Woods Crescent, St. Johns
Woking	5th/12th April 1981	F. Kitchener, "Halesby", Bullbeggars Lane, Horsham.

SCOUT LEADERS

Croydon	7th/8th February 1981	W.H. Smith, 266 Whitehorse Lane, London, SE25.
Horley	February 1981 (to be finalised)	J.M. Elliot, 22 Parkway, Ratton Manor, Eastbourne.

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse	7th/8th March & 10th May	B.C. Wood, 18 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham.
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GROUP SCOUT LEADERS

(GL-SW)	21st/22nd March 1981	W. Howard Smith, 266 Whitehorse Lane, London SE25.
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Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Cheam (non-residential)	Sundays 1st, 8th, 22nd and 29th March 1981	D. Brown, 21 Langsmead, Blindley Heath, RH7 6JT.
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Pack Holiday Course

Polyapes	11th/12th April 1981	Miss M. Pooley, 71 Beech Grove, Mitcham.
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Scout Headquarters

As a young leader in Surrey back in 1944, I can remember the first issue of the "Surrey 'S' Sheet". Sometimes, as the issues appeared, I would read everything, sometimes I seemed to miss things. In any event, since I had come from a County where such a Newsletter did not exist, I felt that I knew a little about what was going on in the County and I certainly fancied I knew its many personalities. I did not realise at the time that it was the means whereby the County was communicating with me. It has done so now for 400 issues and is, in my opinion, one of the most useful County Newsletters - it is concise, informative, thought provoking and regular. Thirty years of publication is a great achievement and worthy of heartiest congratulations - may the "Surrey Scout" long serve the Scouters of this County and beyond.

KEN STEVENS
Chief Executive Commissioner

It seems many years ago - and indeed it is - that I was a Group Scouter in a District which was then part of the Scout County of Surrey. I can well remember the value of what was then entitled the "Surrey 'S' Sheet" and how useful it was in keeping Scouters in Groups in touch with what was going on in the County and beyond.

Communication is a subject which can be relied upon to be discussed for a very long time at any Meeting or Conference. Good communication depends not only on the value of what is being communicated

but on the way the communication is set out so that those who receive it may feel moved to read it! The "Surrey Scout" is readable and there really is no excuse for anybody to say that 'I have not been told'.

Your hard working Editor and distributor sends copies to Headquarters and we always look forward to receiving them and reading about what is going on in a County which for me, was where it all began.

TED HAYDEN
Executive Commissioner (Administration)
Secretary, The Scout Association

The previous editions of the "Surrey Scout" have over the years been a regular visitor to the Public Relations Department at Headquarters.

I have personally found it particularly helpful in the way it has presented a mirror image of Scouting in Surrey. This impression has in turn been confirmed by my personal acquaintance over the years with Scouters and Scouts from the County.

As I write, I recall their names and the particular events that cause me to remember them in particular. They each helped to widen my horizons and the one thing, amongst others, that they all had in common was that all of them without exception gave one a very favourable impression of Scouting in Surrey and the Country.

I get the impression that Scouting in Surrey and the "Surrey Scout" will continue to set the pattern for others to follow for many years to come.

JACK OLDEN
Public Relations Officer.

County Chaplain

Around the middle of September there appeared among the many reports that land on my desk in the Church of England's Headquarters one with the title, 'Prospects for the Eighties'. It was the result of a census carried out in November, 1979 for the Nationwide Initiative in Evangelism. Every local Church in England (and there are nearly 40,000 of them) was invited to do some careful counting of the numbers actually in Church on a normal Sunday - rather than giving, as is more common, the official membership figures.

Obviously the significance of the figures must not be over emphasised - some clergy and church secretaries may not have been quite as accurate as others! However, it did show that on a normal November Sunday some 11% of the population was in Church - or nearly four million people, which is certainly far more than, for example, League football draws on its best Saturdays. More significant from our point of

view was the information that the figure for attendance by those aged under 15 was nearly one and half million - or 14% of the available child population. Certainly a considerable drop since a figure of over 30% was produced thirty years ago. On the other hand it is worth noting that the decline in the last five years has been of 0.6% a year - at a time when the total child population was dropping at the rate of 2% a year.

Of course, it is easy to play games with any set of figures - but at least it is good to have some facts rather than hunches about rises and falls. Fourteen per cent is a small proportion of the available children by any standards. It underlines the key role of bodies like the Scout Movement, able to make contact with many youngsters whom the churches are unable to reach. We have a tremendous opportunity to plant the seeds of the idea that God is alive and well in the minds of the boys we serve.

KEITH HUXLEY

It was in June, 1944 that the Surrey Scout Council decided at its A.G.M. that a printed notice sheet should be issued - not at any stated time as there were difficulties over printing and paper - but as and when sufficient news had accumulated. So, in July, "Surrey 'S' Sheet" was born - bannered as "a short supplement of sayings, scribbings, sarcasms and sensible suggestions for the superior Scouters of Surrey".

In what sort of World was it that our first issue found itself? It was war-time, peace was some 10 months away and Scout meetings were being continually interrupted by flying bombs and rockets. Alterations to addresses was poignant, such as "Mitcham Hon. Sec. - home destroyed - present address . . ." "D" Day had only just happened.

In comparing the World of our first issue with that of our 400th it is surprising to note some of the differences. A plea on television for a kidney machine for a boy living in a high-rise flat, which we just accept today, would have been impossible - no kidney machine existed, no high-rise flats and indeed, no television! Hi-fi, pop charts, micro-chips, digital watches, computers, credit cards and hovercraft are just some of the things which the 1944 Scout could not even have dreamt about. Travelling was mainly by walking, bicycle or 'bus and very occasionally train. Cars were few and far between which was a pity because the driver had no traffic jams, parking meters, traffic wardens, yellow lines; fewer traffic lights and other traffic signs; there were few garages and no choice of petrol. Food (and sweets) were strictly rationed, one egg and 2 oz. butter per person per week for instance. The pre-packed and frozen foods of today were totally unknown.

Money was quite different then, in value and in coin. 12 pennies made 1 shilling, 20 shillings made £1. Potatoes were 5 lb. for 6d. (2½p), 20 cigarettes cost

2/6d (12½p), a bicycle was £6 and a letter cost 2½d (.96p) to send - there was no first or second class post. Income Tax was 10/- (50p) in the £.

And what of Scouts? Many Scoutmasters (as they then were) had been called up for service in the Forces so that Groups carried on as best they could, especially the Troop. And what happened? Troops were forced to work the Patrol System and surprise, it not only worked well, it worked better than any other system. There were 2,000 more Boy Scouts in 1944 than there were in 1938. And perhaps that was why there were almost 3 Boy Scouts for every 2 Wolf Cubs throughout the country at that time. No Scout uniform was impossible so Groups had uniform exchange arrangements, boys and parents also made various items - it was the day of short trousers and large-brimmed hats - and most Scouts turned out to Troop Meeting in full and complete uniform. Most Troops' pride and joy was the trek cart which was cleaned and looked after with loving care. Subscriptions varied as they do today, but 2d (.8p) or 3d (1.2p) per week was the most usual. "The Scouter" cost 4/6d (22½p) per annum, "Scouting" now costs £10.40 per annum. "Gilcraft" books cost from 2/6d (12½p) each.

Gradually changes have come about, many not without difficulties, new things have appeared and well known things have faded away. What sort of World will it be when we publish the 800th issue of "Surrey Scout" - or whatever it is then called. Will we, as a very lively part of the Scout Association (we are the 4th largest County in the Country), keep abreast of the times and keep Scouting up-to-date, but in so doing stick rigidly to those first principles so firmly laid down by our Founder?

DOUG. BENNETT

Surrey Venture Scout Rifle Club

The Club held its Annual Shoot at Bisley on 12th October, the weather was kind, being sunny with little wind. 18 teams of 4 from 14 Units took part and the standard of shooting was good. The Club welcomed its new President, Lt.-Gen. Sir David Scott-Barrett, K.B.E., M.C., who presented the trophies at the end of the proceedings.

For the first time in the history of the Club, a lady

won the Donegal Badge for the highest score in the afternoon; Celia Duval from 1st Fetcham who also won the Ladies Plate, scored 44 out of a possible 50.

138 Unit from Banstead District won the County Shield with a top score of 142, 1st Fetcham 'A' Team came second with 140, 7th Woking was third with 137. The President's Cup for the highest individual score in the morning practice was won by Andrew McIndoe of 1st Horley.

Pieces and Bits Thanks

Fire!

We were very sorry to hear of the fire which completely gutted the headquarters of Holy Trinity Group in Guildford District - the Group has lost all of its equipment and some irreplaceable trophies. The Group was properly insured so will be able to replace its equipment. Plans for a new headquarters are well under way but a marley-type building is envisaged in place of the wooden building so there is a Fund started for the extra £10,000 which will be required.

What would have happened if it had been your headquarters that was burnt down? It could happen to you as easily as it happened to Holy Trinity. Is your insurance adequate - really adequate - and is the premium paid up to date? Districts - ask all the Groups in your District to send in insurance details and see what shocks you find.

Accident

We were sorry to hear that Mrs. Janet Wood (Secretary, Venture Scout Sub-Committee and wife of Bruce) has suffered a broken collarbone and wish her a speedy recovery.

County Directory

County

A.L.T. F. Kitchener. Address now "Halesby", Bullbeggars Lane, Horsell, Woking. Tel. 69389
Sec. Scout Sub-Committee. B. Parker, address now Flat 6, 59 Cavendish Road, Colliers Wood, London S.W.19. Tel. 01-542 8827.

Staines

A.D.C. (S.F.) Insert J. Swansborough, 28 Brightside Avenue, Staines, Middx. Tel. Staines 57534

Walton & Weybridge

Treasurer B. Clarke. Telephone Number should be Walton-on-Thames 20975 and not as stated.

P.R.O. Insert R. Kirkbride, 45 Burwood Road, Hersham, Walton-on-Thames. Tel. 25061.

County Diary

November

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| 1 | Swimming Gala | Guildford |
| 8 | District Commissioners' Symposium | Bentley Copse |
| 15-16 | Venture Competition | |

December

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| 2 | Water Activities Sub-Committee | Staines |
| 4 | Venture Scout Sub Committee | Dorking |

December "Surrey Scout"

Copy Date	14th November
Distribution	30th November

It is not inappropriate to stop for a moment and to think of all those people who keep "Surrey Scout" alive.

Thank you, our contributors. It is no easy task to try to think of something fresh and new to say each month, our various County Commissioners have managed to do this without exception. And our other contributors, especially the A.C.Cs, also do us proud (some 'do us' a little more often than others!). And they've learnt not to be late with their copy!

Thank you, our typesetter whose accuracy is outstanding. Out of all the copy for each "Surrey Scout", it is unusual to find more than one or two mistakes. We say "our" typesetter the lady in question is really working for our printers and typesets GLSW News as well as many other things (mostly not connected with Scouting) but we still like to think of her as "our" typesetter.

Thank you, our printers, Stringer Briggs Stockley & Co., of Kingston, who have printed every issue of "Surrey Scout" and "Surrey 'S' Sheet". Besides being extremely helpful over the years, the standard of work is excellent and the number of mistakes incredibly few. In spite of national disputes, paper shortages, holidays, sickness and the hundred and one other things which can go wrong; during the last 8 years at least, not one of the 90 issues has been late - a tremendous record.

Thank you, our distributors. We receive surprisingly few complaints that "Surrey Scout" is not getting through; and when it doesn't it is so easy to blame the District Distributor. So often, the fault lies with a Group or even a section of a Group. We believe that the District Distributors do a fine job - dealing with mountains of paper, not just "Surrey Scout". The bundles are counted out and then pushed around the District and this is done quickly and well.

Thank you, our readers, be you Scouter, Administrator or Supporter. It is for you that everyone goes to so much trouble and it is you who should benefit. And, you know, there is no reason at all why, once in a while, instead of being last in the line, you could be first. Yes, be a contributor!